

STEADY PRESS

Headache & Migraine Log

Track every attack — timing, triggers, aura, medication and what finally stopped it — in a format neurologists recognise.

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FORMAT

A4

PAGES

10

USE

Print as many copies as you need

THE ROUTINE

- ☐ Fill an attack log for every headache, however mild
- ☐ Note the warning signs before the pain arrives
- ☐ Record rescue medication and the exact time taken
- ☐ Shade the monthly calendar every evening
- ☐ Review triggers at the end of each month
- ☐ Take the summary to your neurologist

THE SCALE YOU WILL USE

NO PAIN 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 WORST IMAGINABLE

WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

- 1 Noticeable, easy to ignore 3 Annoying, does not stop you 5 Hard to concentrate through 7 Limits what you can do
- 9 Unable to function

Medication-overuse headache is diagnosed from a count of rescue doses per month. Keeping that count honest is the single most useful thing on these pages.

This is a record-keeping tool, not medical advice. Bring it to a professional rather than using it to self-diagnose.

WHAT I WANT TO GET OUT OF THIS

Attack log

DATE	STARTED	ENDED	TOTAL HOURS

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

MILD WORST

☐ One side — left
 ☐ One side — right
 ☐ Both sides

☐ Behind the eye
 ☐ Forehead / temples
 ☐ Base of skull

☐ Top of head
 ☐ Whole head
 ☐ Moved during attack

☐ Throbbing / pulsing	☐ Pressing / tight band	☐ Stabbing
☐ Worse with movement	☐ Nausea	☐ Vomiting
☐ Light sensitivity	☐ Sound sensitivity	☐ Smell sensitivity
☐ Visual aura	☐ Tingling or numbness	☐ Speech difficulty

TIME	WHAT	DOSE	RELIEF (0-10)	HOW LONG UNTIL RELIEF

WARNING SIGNS

Prodrome & aura

Many people have reliable warning signs hours before the pain. Finding yours buys you treatment time.

HOURS BEFORE AN ATTACK I OFTEN NOTICE

- ☐ Yawning repeatedly
- ☐ Unusual thirst
- ☐ Irritability or low mood
- ☐ Difficulty finding words
- ☐ Light seems too bright
- ☐ Difficulty concentrating
- ☐ Food cravings
- ☐ Neck stiffness
- ☐ Unusual energy or elation
- ☐ Blurred vision
- ☐ Frequent urination
- ☐ Sensitivity to smells

WARNING-SIGN LOG

DATE	SIGN NOTICED	HOURS BEFORE PAIN	DID EARLY TREATMENT HELP?

Trigger tracker

COMMON TRIGGERS TO TEST

- ☐ Missed or late meal
- ☐ Alcohol — red wine
- ☐ Chocolate
- ☐ Stress, or the let-down after
- ☐ Strong smells
- ☐ Poor or excess sleep
- ☐ Caffeine, or withdrawal
- ☐ Bright or flickering light
- ☐ Weather change
- ☐ Neck or jaw tension
- ☐ Dehydration
- ☐ Aged cheese
- ☐ Screen time
- ☐ Hormonal cycle
- ☐ Exercise

SUSPECTED TRIGGER LOG

DATE	EXPOSURE	HOURS TO ONSET	SEVERITY	CONFIRMED?

OVERVIEW

Monthly headache calendar

Shade every day you had any head pain at all, including the mild ones you would normally forget.

MONTH

YEAR

DAY OF MONTH

M	T	W	T	F	S	S
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

KEY

☐ Mild ☒ Moderate ☐ Severe ☐ Rescue medication taken ☐ Aura

MONTH TOTALS

HEADACHE DAYS	SEVERE DAYS	RESCUE DOSES	DAYS OFF WORK
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More than ten rescue doses in a month is worth raising with your doctor — overuse can itself cause headaches.

EVERY SUNDAY

Weekly review

Ten minutes looking back is where the pattern actually shows up.

WEEK OF

BEST DAY

WORST DAY

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY

AVG PAIN

SLEEP

NOTABLE

WHAT MADE IT BETTER

WHAT MADE IT WORSE

ONE THING TO CHANGE NEXT WEEK

APPOINTMENT

Doctor visit prep

Fill this in the day before. Most appointments are short — walking in with this changes what you get out of it.

DATE OF VISIT

SEEING

IN ONE SENTENCE, WHAT IS THE PROBLEM?

THE FACTS

QUESTION

YOUR ANSWER

HAVE YOU ALREADY TRIED

☐ Rest

☐ Heat

☐ Ice

☐ Stretching

☐ Painkillers

☐ Physio

☐ Massage

☐ New pillow

☐ Desk changes

QUESTIONS I WANT ANSWERED

WHAT WAS DECIDED

Notes

Anything the structured pages did not capture.

Before you start

These pages are a personal record-keeping tool. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose anything, and nothing here is medical advice.

Tracking is useful because it turns vague memory into specifics you can hand to a professional: when it started, what makes it worse, what you already tried. It is not a substitute for seeing one.

See a qualified healthcare professional about any new, severe, or worsening symptom. Seek urgent care for chest pain, numbness or weakness in a limb, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe headache of sudden onset, pain following an accident, fever with neck stiffness, or any symptom that frightens you.

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